Richard Dillman

Fractional Engineering Leader · Scaling Teams & Systems

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Summary

Hands-on engineering leader who builds high-traffic web platforms and the teams behind them. Rose from Senior Application Engineer to Senior Director of Engineering at The Muse, promoted 6 engineers to senior or lead roles, and generated $994K in annual revenue by replacing a decade-old ad platform. At Talent.com (5-8M pageviews/day), restored Google Jobs indexing from zero to 1.5M+ jobs a day and raised test coverage from 59% to 91%. Open to fractional engineering leadership engagements.

Skills

Leadership: Engineering Leadership · Mentoring and Career Growth · Technical Strategy · Platform Modernization · PRDs and RFCs · AI-Assisted Development
Platform: TypeScript · React · Next.js · Node.js · Python · PostgreSQL · AWS · Kubernetes · Kafka · Datadog · Grafana
SEO and Growth: Technical SEO · Structured Data · Google Search Console · Core Web Vitals

Work Experience

Talent.com **Dec 2025 - Present**

Staff Software Engineer Dec 2025 - Present

Embedded with a 10-engineer team: find the highest-cost problems, write the fix plan, and route each fix to the team's engineers or ship it directly.

- Identified $60K/year in recoverable Google Geocoding spend, confirmed by Finance, in a service consolidation plan.
- Measured 45% duplication across job data sources and drove a cross-team decision to show one copy of each job without losing revenue.
- Restored Google Jobs indexing from zero to 1.5M+ new jobs a day by finding the real cause behind 15.9M rejected submissions.
- Gated non-job listings out of Google for Jobs without losing their on-site search and ad revenue, and linked translations with hreflang.
- Raised jobseeker test coverage from 59% to 91% and shipped a staged framework upgrade on a 5-8M pageviews/day frontend with zero production regressions.
- Traced a soft-404 spike of 39.5M URLs in Google Search Console to its root cause and shipped the redirect and bot-detection fixes.
- Migrated 4 frontends to a new authentication library behind a dual-implementation flag with zero auth downtime.
- Launched a team-shared AI development platform of 30+ Claude Code skills and a multi-agent review pipeline that checks tests, security, accessibility, and performance on every merge request.

The Muse **Dec 2018 - Sep 2025**

Senior Director of Engineering Jan 2022 - Sep 2025

- Led a 15-engineer team and promoted 6 engineers to senior or lead roles through mentorship and quarterly growth reviews.
- Increased job applications per user 50% by redesigning search into a two-pane layout with inline browsing.
- Grew SEO visits 74K/month by replacing infinite scroll with server-side pagination.
- Architected a white-label, multi-tenant job search platform projected at $153K-$230K annual revenue per partner tenant.

- Launched Maya, The Muse's first AI content discovery tool, adding 3,500 article readers a month across 24K+ articles.
- Increased job applies 10% and CTR 15% by replacing Madgex, a third-party apply layer, with in-house ATS-integrated forms.
- Increased ad revenue 15% by migrating to Raptive with improved layouts and formats.
- Introduced Claude as The Muse's first AI contributor, running automated code review and issue management in daily workflows.

Staff Engineer, Director of Application Development — Jun 2020 - Dec 2021

- Generated $994K in annual revenue by replacing a 10+ year-old ad system that predated Google Ad Manager with a modern display ad integration.
- Increased job tile clicks 21.9% and views per user 20% with a search UX refresh that passed Core Web Vitals.
- Increased job search conversions 13% with a Trending Search module and CTR 22% through UX experiments.

Staff Engineer — Mar 2019 - May 2020

- Grew organic SEO traffic 10x with JSON-LD structured data and performance refactors.
- Cut build times from 45 minutes to 75 seconds by modularizing repos and rebuilding the CI/CD pipelines.
- Reduced regression bugs 30%+ by standardizing on ESLint, Jest, and Puppeteer and mentoring the team on them.

Senior Application Engineer — Dec 2018 - Feb 2019

- Cut new project setup from 2-3 weeks to 2-3 days with a Next.js, Koa, Docker, and CircleCI template adopted org-wide.

Condé Nast — **Jul 2015 - Nov 2018**

Senior Software Engineer, Ad Tech and Monetization — Jul 2015 - Nov 2018

- Increased ad viewability from 45% to 85% by rebuilding ad infrastructure for 30+ global publications (Vogue, The New Yorker, Wired, GQ, Vanity Fair) serving 229M+ monthly users.
- Reached 80%+ test coverage across a 45-engineer editorial engineering org through standardized testing and documentation.
- Authored the RFCs and migration plans for the ad platform rebuild, mentored engineers, and coordinated ad vendors and programmatic exchanges.

Open-Source Projects

- **seo-audit-mcp** and **googlebot-simulator-mcp:** MCP servers for technical SEO audits and verifying bot detection and analytics as Googlebot.